

and logging wireless networks. With a high-powered antenna, GPS, and a laptop, war drivers can detect and plot your network on a global grid. These war drivers then file the location of your network into a permanent database on the web. Once an unsecured network is found by these war drivers, anyone can pinpoint the exact location of your network (complete with road maps) on the internet. Go to www.wigle.net to see if your network is already one of the 1,881,793 Wi-Fi networks that have been logged already.

MAC address filtering can do the job. MAC address filtering is dangerous because it provides a false sense of security to the unsuspecting. Many wireless access points and routers allow MAC address filtering—a low level check on the MAC address or identifier of your wireless interface—to determine if a particular PC should be allowed access on the network. There are 2 significant problems with MAC address filtering. First, it doesn't prevent passive attacks. A hacker can still capture and listen to your network traffic without ever being seen. And second, if hackers want access to your network, they need only listen for a valid MAC address, and change the MAC address on their PC to match a valid address. This can be done in less than a minute.

WEP Security is good enough. WEP (Wired Equivalent Privacy) uses common 60 or 108 bit key shared among all of the devices on the network to encrypt the wireless data. Unfortunately, WEP is a very weak form of security. Hackers can access tools freely available on the internet like WEPcrack, Aircrack, and Aircrack-ng that can crack a WEP key in as little as 15 minutes. Once the WEP key is cracked, the network traffic instantly turns into clear text—making it easy for the hacker to treat the network like any open network.

The Five Deadly Dangers Of Unsecured Wireless Networks

Once hackers have access to your network, they can readily capture personal and business information. There are two types of attacks. Passive attacks, where the hacker captures your network